

This assignment brief consists
of 7 pages, each is identified
by the Code Number
LUBS189001

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(Semester 1, 2023/2024)

Assessed Coursework

LUBS1890 Starting Your Own Business

100% Assignment

Assessment on this module will be done on an individual basis. Each student will be required to identify an opportunity for an idea within a particular market, demonstrate the feasibility of this opportunity, and discuss the competitiveness of the proposed idea in this written assignment which will include:

1. 2,500 word written report.
2. A visual representation of a Blue Ocean Canvas.

This assignment brief includes a detailed description for developing your written assignment.

This assignment is designed to increase your critical evaluation of the attractiveness of an opportunity.

- In the first part of the assignment, you should demonstrate your ability to analyse the feasibility of the identified business opportunity (e.g. gap or problem in a market).
- In the second part of the assignment, you will propose an idea of *a product or service* to address the identified opportunity, and demonstrate your ability to apply the Blue Ocean Canvas to indicate the competitiveness of your idea in comparison to other offerings in the market. The proposed idea does not have to be a new to the world innovation, but it also can't be an existing business. As such, it can be an improvement of an existing idea by making it, for example, more user friendly, more accessible, more cost effective, less time consuming, more adaptable to the needs of a particular group... etc. So you can think about improving the product, the accessibility, the services, the processes, the promotion, the design... etc.

This written assignment is based on your learning throughout the module, and will include:

- 1. Title:** This will be the name of your product/ service idea. Try to come up with a catchy name!
- 2. 200 word Report Summary:**
Introduce the identified opportunity briefly, and the industry and target market for it. Then mention the idea of the product/ service which you propose to address that opportunity. Highlight that the purpose of this report is to analyse the

feasibility of the identified opportunity based on analysing secondary data. Mention how the data is “accessed” (i.e. what sources did you use e.g. IBISWorld, Passport, journals, books... etc., which are available in the electronic library resources of the university). Also add that the report will demonstrate the competitiveness of the proposed idea through Blue Ocean Strategy. End the abstract by briefly indicating why your business idea is feasible (you might want to stress some uniqueness here!).

3. Table of contents

Include a table of contents indicating how you have organised this report. Use this assignment brief as an indicative guide for what needs to be included.

4. Entrepreneur feasibility analysis:

- Introduce yourself (remember that YOU can be part of the value proposition). In this part, you will tell us why you think you are the best person to conduct this idea; e.g. mention who you are, what your background is, any specific experiences, skills, motivations that you have and can support your engagement in this particular business idea.
- This is the only section in the assignment, where you can use 1st person. However, remember that you cannot mention your name in this section or anywhere else in the assignment to protect anonymity
- You do not need to include any references in this section, unless you would like to refer to any particular frameworks or literature that might be relevant to your discussion.

5. Market feasibility analysis:

(You should correctly cite all references used in this section)

- The opportunity and the broad size of the opportunity: Introduce the identified opportunity, which can be a problem or gap that exists within a particular market (e.g. an illness, disorder, disability, problems with delivery or accessibility, problems related to Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs)... etc.). Give a broad indication of how big this problem is within the context that you are looking into (e.g. you might refer to the size of the problem globally and/or at the level of the country as a whole here).
- Target market and the size of the opportunity within that target market: introduce the target market that you want to focus on in relation to the opportunity identified. Describe your target market as long as many dimensions as you have defined (e.g. demographic, geographic, psychographic, needs, trends...). Based on this segmentation, analyse the attractiveness of the identified opportunity within this target market by considering, for example, the number of people within that target market that are affected by the gap/ problem identified, the frequency or the prevalence of the gap/ problem within that specific target market, the potential size (or frequency and prevalence) of relevant psychographic trends, or other indicators that stress the size of the opportunity.

6. Industry feasibility analysis:

(You should correctly cite all references used in this section)

- Industry and the size of the opportunity within that industry: What industry or industries will your business operate in? How large is your total industry (or industries)? How fast is the industry(s) growing? And any other indicators that stress the attractiveness of the industry(s).
- What factors and trends influence the demand and supply within your industry and market (e.g. think about the main threats and drivers within

the industry and market by considering Porter's Forces and PEST factors. DO NOT present a Porter's forces analysis or a PEST analysis here. Just consider these tools to identify the current and anticipated characteristics and trends in the market that can affect the demand and supply of your product/ service (e.g. these can relate to wider social, political and environmental trends, but can also relate to suppliers, competitors, distributors... and the threats they can pose on your business).

7. Introduce your Blue Ocean Strategy by:

- Propose an idea of a product or service to serve the opportunity identified earlier. Make sure this idea creates value for its users beyond that already offered by other competitors.
- Compare your idea against the norms that prevail in the industry (i.e. factors that are taken for granted by competitors). You may want to present these in a grid or in bullet points. Do not add much detail here; just mention the factors briefly. Here, you need to highlight at least two factors under each of the following four domains:
 - Factors to raise above the industry norms
 - Factors to reduce below the industry norms
 - Factors to eliminate, which the industry norms have taken for granted, and thus commonly offer
 - Factors to create, which the industry norms have never offered

8. Present the visual representation of your Blue Ocean Canvas (BOC):

- Your BOC should include 2 lines: one for your product/service, and the other one representing the industry norm. It is understood of course that your idea can possibly be compared against two different norms in the industry sometimes, however, for the purpose of this assignment, it would be enough to compare it against one norm only.
- Do not include specific names of competitors in the BOC, rather include the trends (norms) of competition
- The x-axis in your canvas should include the key success factors, including a minimum of 8 factors, with two under each of the four domains of raise, reduce, eliminate and create.
- The y-axis should include a general description of: High, Medium and Low. You should not include specific statistics/ figures/ numbers on the y-axis
- The Key success factor presented in your BOC can be based on your own analysis in the previous sections, so you do not need to reference your discussion in this section of the assignment, unless those factors were derived from a specific source.
- The visual representation of your BOC should follow the guidance for developing the canvas as explained in the lessons.

9. Concluding note summarizing the feasibility and attractiveness of your business idea: (around 200-300 words here)

In your summary, conclude by highlighting the extent to which your idea proves to be feasible based on the feasibility analysis conducted. Also highlight the competitiveness of your product/ service to the target market as evident through the Blue Ocean Canvas. Your summary should explain how your competitive value proposition can support the business in exploiting opportunities through emphasizing key success factors that make your business unique (e.g. consider the create factors here).

10. List of references

Helpful notes:

- Make sure you go through the content of Lectures 2, 3 & 4 (on weeks 4, 5 & 8), which discuss your assignment development in detail, alongside some useful examples.
- Make sure you go through the FAQs page on Minerva (Under Assessment and Feedback) for further information and tips.
- Do not forget that you must use your student ID as the "Title" when submitting. DO NOT include your name. Your name should not show in any part of the assignment neither.
- The relevant coversheet to be submitted with your assignment can be found [Here](#).
- Avoid writing in first person except in section 4 (Entrepreneur Feasibility Analysis)
- Reference the assignment properly. Any in-text citations should be fully referenced in your list of references.
- As a minimum requirement, you need to cite two industry and market reports, and two journal articles (or books/ book chapters). These references are necessary to support your discussion in sections 5 & 6 (Market Feasibility Analysis & Industry Feasibility Analysis). You do not need to include any references in the other sections of the assignment unless you needed to cite any particular frameworks or literature that support your discussion.
- Adjust the layout to have the line spacing at 1.5, paragraph spacing at Auto, and using 12 Times New Roman font.
- Apply the Harvard Referencing Style following the University of Leeds referencing guide available [Here](#)
- You are advised to develop your assignment following the structure as indicated in this assignment brief.
- You are not expected to complete a full feasibility analysis in this assignment. Therefore, follow the structure and complete ONLY the requested sections as indicated. For example, this assignment does NOT include a financial feasibility analysis. Also, you are NOT expected to collect any primary data for the purpose of this assignment.
- Secondary data sources can be accessed through the university library website at: https://library.leeds.ac.uk/info/1100/search_resources
- To access industry and market reports, you may wish to consider the electronic library resources available for you through IBISWorld, Passport and others. You may also refer to the 'Statistics and data sources' at (https://library.leeds.ac.uk/info/1100/search_resources). These will give you access to a lot of market trends and characteristics. E.g. one of the many resources available in (The UK Data service, available @ <https://library.leeds.ac.uk/subjects/1178/politics-and-international-studies#database-483>) that will give you access to (Guide to using UK Data Service). From the latter guide, you will get to analyse many trends by considering different themes, geography, demographics... Many other electronic library resources are also available. Remember to correctly cite sources!
- You may include pictures, graphs, tables...etc. in your report to demonstrate your idea & support your discussion more clearly if you think that helps. Remember to cite those.
- The assignment structure on Minerva gives some details on how the week-by-week delivery on the module links back to the assignment development.

Assignments should be a maximum of 2,500 words in length, including the report summary, the table of contents, the visual representation of the BOC, and any tables or diagrams included. The word count excludes the cover page, references and appendices. EVERYTHING else is included in the wordcount.

All coursework assignments that contribute to the assessment of a module are subject to a word limit, as specified on the assessment brief. **The word limit is an extremely important aspect of good academic practice, and must be adhered to.** Unless stated otherwise in the relevant module handbook (if one has been provided), the word count includes EVERYTHING (i.e. all text in the main body of the assignment including summaries, subtitles, contents pages, tables, supportive material whether in footnotes or in-text references) except the main title, reference list and/or bibliography and any appendices. It is not acceptable to present matters of substance, which should be included in the main body of the text, in the appendices ("appendix abuse"). *It is not acceptable to attempt to hide words in graphs and diagrams; only text which is strictly necessary should be included in graphs and diagrams.*

You are required to adhere to the word limit specified and state an accurate word count on the cover page of your assignment brief. Your declared word count must be accurate, and should not mislead. Making a fraudulent statement concerning the work submitted for assessment could be considered academic malpractice and investigated as such. If the amount of work submitted is higher than that specified by the word limit or that declared on your word count, this may be reflected in the mark awarded and noted through individual feedback given to you.

The deadline date for this assignment is before 12:00:00 noon on Tuesday 12th December 2023.

An electronic copy of the assignment must be submitted to the Assignment Submission area within the module resource on the Blackboard MINERVA website no later than 12:00:00 noon prompt on the deadline date.

Faxed, emailed or hard copies of the assignment will not be accepted.

Failure to meet this initial deadline will result in a reduction of marks, details of which can be found at the following place: <https://students.business.leeds.ac.uk/assessment/code-of-practice-on-assessment/>

SUBMISSION

Please ensure that you leave sufficient time to complete the online submission process, as upload times can vary. Accessing the submission link before the deadline does **NOT** constitute completion of submission. You **MUST** click the '**CONFIRM**' button before 12:00:00 noon for your assignment to be

classed as submitted on time, if not you will need to submit to the Late Area and your assignment will be marked as late. It is your responsibility to ensure you upload the correct file to the MINERVA, and that it has uploaded successfully.

It is important that any file submitted follows the conventions stated below:

FILE NAME

The name of the file that you upload must be your student ID only.

ASSIGNMENT TITLE

During the submission process the system will ask you to enter the title of your submission. This should also be your student ID only.

FRONT COVER

The first page of your assignment should always be the Assessed Coursework Coversheet (individual), which is available to download from the following location: <https://students.business.leeds.ac.uk/forms-guidance-and-coversheets/>

STUDENT NAME

You should **NOT** include your name anywhere on your assignment

Feedback grid and qualitative criteria for assessment of LUBS1890 assignment

	Structure	Analysis & Understanding	Visual representation	Academic Referencing
Excellent	An outstanding to very high standard of writing and communication and presentation from the beginning to the end. Correct length, clear, logical, good use of language and a few minor errors of grammar and spelling. Good use of diagrams and/or tables.	Work demonstrates a very high standard of critical analysis and/or originality and creativity. Employs ideas, concepts, and integrates secondary data and theory to good effect.	An outstanding to high standard visual representation. An excellent level of creativity that relates to the analysis in an explicit manner, indicating understanding and articulation. An excellent level of creativity and novelty noted.	Wide range of relevant sources used and appropriately referenced in line with the assignment outline. Relevant and well-articulated referencing conventions.
Very Good	Clearly structured work displaying an ability to deal with the concepts, sources and arguments relevant to the topic under discussion and critical judgement in selecting, evaluating and organising material.	Wide appropriate knowledge and integration of secondary data and theory. Evidence of understanding and integration of concepts. Where appropriate, some evidence of originality and/or critical analysis, with only occasional lapses in detail	Very good visual representation that indicates good understanding of the analysis. Adequate novelty noted, with some technical lapses.	A good standard of referencing, though a few errors or inconsistencies may be present. Good referencing conventions but possibly containing technical errors, some minor, some more serious
Good	Sound and competent work which covers the basic subject matter and is appropriately organised and presented.	Overall good understanding of concepts, but might be lacking on grounds of sufficiently well-structured arguments, and offering adequate evidence to justify assertions	Good visual representation with satisfactory relation to the analysis, but not offering adequate novelty. Occasional technical lapses noted.	Referencing satisfactory on the whole, though some inconsistencies or instances of poor/ limited citation may be present. Some weaknesses in composition and use of referencing conventions
Satisfactory	Barely satisfactory standard of presentation. Some inaccuracies/errors may be of a more serious nature	Familiarity with some of the main concepts, but with limited understanding, sometimes erroneous. Limited integration of secondary data and theory. No evidence for a critical approach showing an appreciation of the pros and cons of the presented analysis.	Barely satisfactory visual representation that indicates limited understanding of the analysis. It does not offer adequate novelty. A number of technical lapses noted.	Citations present, but referencing is poor, suggesting that little effort has been made to extract relevant references and/ or follow guidance. Many errors, some serious, revealing limited awareness of academic scholarship
Poor	Little evidence that any thought has been given to the standard of presentation. Many serious errors/inaccuracies	Aware of very few key concepts. Demonstrating poor understanding. No evidence for a critical approach. Answers not particularly focused on the question set.	Very poor visual representation that indicates lack of understanding of the analysis. It does not offer any novelty. Frequent technical lapses noted.	Citation almost or entirely absent. Guidance largely ignored. Evidence of awareness of academic scholarship is very weak

END